

ANIMALS IN DANGER

Sumatran orangutan

⚠️ IUCN status: critically endangered
📉 Population estimate: 13,500

Tapanuli orangutan

⚠️ IUCN status: critically endangered
📉 Population estimate: 800

Bornean orangutan

⚠️ IUCN status: critically endangered
📉 Population estimate: 104,000

Baby orangutan

An orangutan spends more time with its mother than almost any other animal. A baby clings to its mother for its first year, but even after seven years, youngsters may still seek their mother's protection.

Tapanuli orangutan

Only recently discovered in the rugged Tapanuli region, this rare ape was described as a separate species in 2017. Illegal hunting and tree-felling have left very few adult individuals.

Sumatran orangutan

The Sumatran orangutan has a cinnamon-colored, long, fleecy, coat. Logging and plantations have pushed them up to the north of the island, and babies are caught for the illegal pet trade.

20%

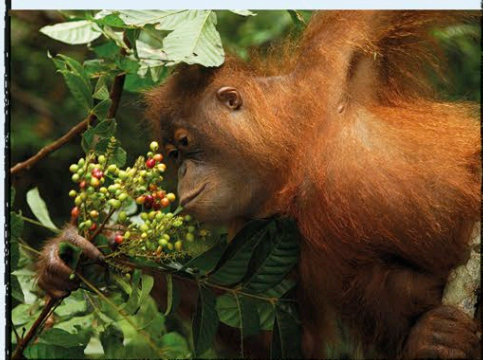
OF WILD ORANGUTANS LIVE IN PROTECTED AREAS



UP TO 3,000 BORNEAN ORANGUTANS ARE KILLED BY HUMANS EVERY YEAR

Tree living

Orangutans spend more time in the branches than the great apes of Africa (see pp.124–125). In the trees, they eat mainly fruit and leaves, and only rarely descend to the ground. They are also less sociable than chimpanzees and gorillas, except when breeding and raising young.



Island refuges

Orangutans once used to range across mainland Southeast Asia, but today they are only found in a few areas on the islands of Sumatra and Borneo in Indonesia.

KEY

Orange: Sumatran orangutan
Red: Tapanuli orangutan
Yellow: Bornean orangutan

